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Claude Code

Guide for Beginners

Claude Code is Anthropic's AI coding agent that reads your entire project, understands your codebase, and works with you like a senior dev who never sleeps.

* Welcome to Claude Code

CLAUDE
CODE



🔔 Login successful. Press **Enter** to continue

This carousel covers everything:

✓ What you need
✓ Key commands

✓ How to install
✓ What it can actually build, fix & automate

✓ How to log in



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What Is Claude Code, Really?

Not just a chatbot. An actual coding agent.

Most AI tools require you to paste your code in manually. Claude Code is different.

Once you launch it inside your project folder, it:



Reads your entire file structure automatically



Understands relationships between files



Writes, edits, and deletes code across multiple files at once



Can run terminal commands on your behalf

Think of it as having a junior developer permanently embedded in your project — one who reads docs, writes tests, and never asks for a raise.

It doesn't just suggest code. It does the work.

What You Need Before You Start

3 Prerequisites — Check These First



A computer with a terminal

Mac



Terminal or iTerm2
Windows



PowerShell or Windows
Terminal Linux

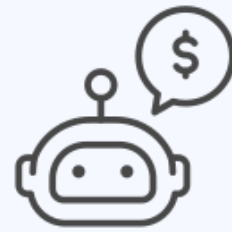


Any shell you already use



A coding project you want to work on

Doesn't matter if it's Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Go, Rust — Claude Code works with any language and reads your files regardless of stack.



A paid Claude subscription

The free plan does NOT include Claude Code. You need at minimum the Pro plan at ~\$20/month. Teams & Enterprise plans also include it.

If you're a serious developer, the Pro plan pays for itself in hours saved within the first week.



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Step 1: Install Claude Code

One Command. No Setup Wizard. No Config File.

Installing Claude Code takes less than 60 seconds. Open your terminal and run:

Mac or Linux:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

Windows PowerShell:

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

That's genuinely it. The installer:

Downloads the
Claude Code CLI

Adds it to your system
PATH automatically

Requires no manual
configuration

Sets up auto-updates so you're always on the latest version



No npm install. No virtual environments. No Docker.
Just one command and you're done.

Swipe ➡



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Step 2: Log In and Launch

First Launch — 4 Steps, Done Once Forever

Installing Claude Code takes less than 60 seconds. Open your terminal and run:

Step 1 Open your terminal

Step 2 Navigate to your project folder `cd your-project-name`

Step 3 Type `claude` and press Enter

Step 4 A browser window opens automatically — log in with your Anthropic/Claude account

After that first login:

Your session token is saved locally

You never need to authenticate again on that machine

Just `cd` into any project and type `claude` — you're in

From install to first conversation: under 2 minutes total.

Inside Claude Code, you'll see a prompt. You can now type anything — questions, tasks, instructions — in plain English.

Swipe ➡



Step 3: Ask Your First Question

You're In. Now What Do You Say?

Once inside Claude Code, just type what you want to know. It already has context about your project — no copy-pasting needed.

Great starter prompts to try:

what does this project do?

Gets an instant plain-English summary of your codebase

explain the folder structure

Maps out what every folder and key file is responsible for

what technologies and libraries does this project use?

Lists your stack, dependencies, and why they're being used

what would be the best place to add a login feature?

Claude reads your architecture and recommends the right approach

are there any obvious bugs or issues I should know about?

A quick code health check across your whole project

Pro tip:

The more specific your question, the more precise and actionable the answer.



Quick Commands Reference

7 Commands You'll Use Every Single Day

Command

What It Does

`claude`

Opens a conversation in your current project

`claude "fix the build error"`

Sends a single task — Claude completes it and exits

`claude -p "explain this function"`

One-off question, no conversation started

`claude -c`

Resumes your last conversation exactly where you left off

`/help`

Shows a full list of all available commands and options

`/clear`

Clears the conversation history and starts fresh

`exit`

Closes Claude Code and returns to your regular terminal

Bonus flags worth knowing:

`claude --model`

switch between Claude model

`claude --verbose`

see more detail about what Claude is doing under the hood



What Claude Code Can Actually Build & Fix

Build entire features

Describe what you want in plain words. It writes the code across as many files as needed — components, routes, logic, all of it.

Review your changes

Ask it to review a PR, spot edge cases, suggest improvements, or check for security issues before you push.

Debug and fix errors

Paste an error message or describe unexpected behavior. Claude traces it through your codebase and fixes the root cause — not just the symptom.

7 Real Things Claude Code Does For You

Update documentation

It can write or update your README, add inline code comments, generate API docs, and keep your docs in sync with your code.

Handle Git completely

Commit changes, create branches, write descriptive commit messages, resolve merge conflicts, and even review diffs.

Refactor and clean up code

Tell it which files or functions feel messy — it restructures them while preserving behavior.

Write tests

Ask it to write unit tests, integration tests, or end-to-end tests for any function, module, or entire feature.



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Pro Tips to Get the Most Out of Claude Code

10 Power-User Tips Nobody Tells You



Be specific with tasks Instead of: "fix my app" Say: "the login button on /dashboard is not submitting the form — fix it"



Give it context when needed You can still paste relevant snippets or error logs directly — it combines that with your file context.



Use it iteratively Don't ask for everything in one go. Build feature by feature, review each step, then move on.



Ask it to explain its own changes After it edits code, type: explain what you just changed and why — great for learning.



Use /clear between unrelated tasks Keeps the context clean and prevents confusion from earlier conversations bleeding in.



Combine with your own expertise Claude Code is fastest when you know what you want to build — you provide direction, it handles execution.



Let it handle the boring stuff Git commits, writing tests for obvious cases, updating changelogs, formatting code — delegate all of it.

Treat Claude Code like a capable junior dev: give clear briefs, review its output, and iterate together.

You Now Know Everything to Get Started

Here's your complete roadmap:

- 01 **Get Claude Pro** at least \$20/month, worth every dollar
- 02 **Install** one curl/irm command, 60 seconds
- 03 **Navigate** to your project folder with cd
- 04 **Type** claude — log in once, never again
- 05 **Ask in plain English** it reads your files automatically
- 06 **Use the commands** claude -c, /clear, claude -p etc.
- 07 **Delegate the boring tasks** bugs, tests, docs, git, refactors

The developers who learn to work with AI tools like Claude Code aren't just faster — they ship better code with fewer bugs and spend more time on what actually matters.



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